

MSI R4850

Cool Performer

The MSI R4850 is similar to many other HD4850 based graphics cards that are now out in the market. The only difference is that MSI decided to deviate from the stock cooler design and gave it a bigger and better looking GPU cooler. So if you have a transparent cabinet, this card can add some eye candy with its shiny copper heat pipes.

First things first, the heart of the HD 4850 is a 55NM, RV770 chip that has 800 stream processors running at a 625 MHz. You would think that the card is something that runs hot, especially since other cards

that use ATI's reference design do so. This card however, has a custom cooler, and runs cool and quiet. We saw a difference of almost 10 degrees in the temperature as compared to the stock design, even with the air-conditioning turned off.

The MSI R 4850 was able to achieve good scores in our synthetic benchmarks and gaming benchmarks too, with a GPU score of 6670 in 3DMark Vantage which is a strict DX 10 based GPU benchmarking utility.

In games too, it performed rather well, scoring



90, 23, 97.2, 88.4 and 82 frames in *FEAR*, *World in conflict*, *Company of Heroes*, *STALKER* and *Unreal Tournament 3* respectively at a resolution of 1600 x 1200 at maximum detail. It was even able to achieve a frame rate of 18.67 in *Crysis*, which is a game we know will kill all cards.

Overall, this card is a decent performer. It's about Rs 500 to Rs 700 more expensive than cards from other manufacturers (with custom coolers), so we suppose you're paying for the looks!

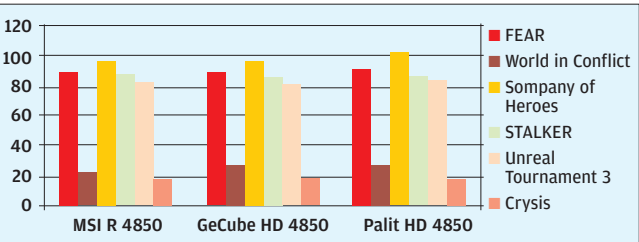
Specifications

625MHz Core / 1986 MHz memory clock, 800 Stream processors, 512MB VRAM, 2 DVI, PCIe 2.0 compliant

Contact: MSI

Phone: 011-41758808/09
E-mail: marketing@msi-in.com
Web site: www.msi.com.tw
Price: Rs 10,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆



OCZ Gold Edition DDR3 RAM

Golden memory

We're soon going to see a transition from DDR2 to DDR3.

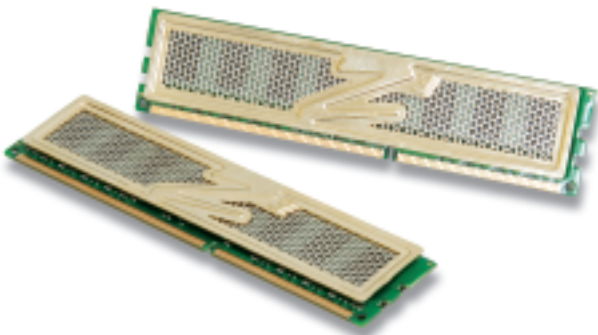
The gold edition DDR3 RAM from OCZ sports a 1333 MHz clock speed. The Honeycomb Grille pattern cooler on it, serves a dual purpose; not only does this make the RAM chips run cooler, it also makes them look cooler!

We tested this RAM on an ASUS rampage extreme (Intel X48 Express chipset) motherboard with Intel X6800 processor and an NVIDIA GTX 280 Graphics card. We were immediately able to see the difference: softwares and games loaded

a lot faster and returned better frame rates.

In our benchmarks, the OCZ RAM performed very well: SiSoft Sandra showed a memory latency of 97 ns — latency in common terms means the time taken to complete a request from the time it was generated. We were able to get a 3DMark Vantage score of 10,956 marks.

The OCZ Gold Edition DDR 3 RAM is a seriously fast little bundle, and there are even faster modules available from OCZ in the market. The price, however, is what will stop you from reaching too eagerly for your



wallet — Rs 15,000 for a kit of 2GB x 2 RAM. If you can actually afford this, buy it, you will not regret it one bit.

Specifications

1333 MHz clock speed, Unbuffered, Honeycomb Grille pattern cooler, features CL 9-9-9 -20 timing.

Contact: Tirupati Enterprises
Phone: 033- 22251192
E-mail: abhishek@tirupati.net
Web site: www.tirupati.net
Price: Rs 14,900

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Microsoft Wireless Laser Desktop 6000

The ERGO-AERO experience

The Microsoft wireless Laser Desktop 6000 tries to make computing comfortable with its ergonomic design, and also complements your need for style with its neat looks and great design.

The Laser Desktop 6000 comprises of a keyboard that is based on Microsoft's Comfort Curve Design; keys have been placed in an ergonomically approved curvaceous design to give your fingers the perfect position and comfort for long hours of work. The keyboard is Windows Vista Aero inspired, and that is why Microsoft has incorporated a few dedicated Vista Aero shortcut keys. The keyboard has a semi transparent border, much like the Aero windows in Vista.

Apart from the basic keys, the keyboard features loads of shortcut keys, with one-touch access to Windows Flip, Zoom, Mail Client and even 5 programmable keys that you can set according to your preference.

The included wireless mouse uses laser technology, which gives it a more precise control as compared to an optical mouse. The tilt wheel allows it to scroll both horizontally as well as vertically. If you are looking forward to a gaming solution, then this will not disappoint you with its responsive mouse, but you might find the keys to lack tactile feedback.

The Microsoft Wireless Laser Desktop 6000 operates at 2.4 GHz wireless radio frequency, allowing it to connect and operate smoothly



without any interference from other electronic wireless devices connected to your computer.

We found the combo to perform well even over large distances. Microsoft claims the operable limit of the hardware is 40 Feet, and is good enough to give you the freedom to connect it to your HTPC. It worked flawlessly for us at a distance of about 15 feet. Both devices operate on 2 AA batteries each, and Microsoft claims they will last for 4 months.

Overall a good set for about Rs 5,500.

Specifications

2.4 Ghz wireless technology, Ergonomic design, Preset and customisable shortcut keys for the keyboard.

Contact: Microsoft Hardware
E-mail: geethakb@microsoft.com
Phone: 9886328580
Web site: www.microsoft.com/india/edd/
Price: Rs 5,427

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Western Digital 1 Terabyte Caviar Black Edition HDD

It don't matter if you're black or white?

With newer Hi-Def video and audio formats becoming popular, games getting larger, and collections growing, you need more space, period. Western Digital plans to satiate your hunger for space with their new 1 Terabyte Caviar Black edition HDD.

This HDD is almost the

same size of a 500GB HDD, despite the increased amount of memory platters. They managed to keep the height low by using perpendicular recording.

The WD caviar comprises of dual processors for twice the data processing speed as normal drives, coupled with a massive 32 MB of buffer memory that ensures that you get the maximum performance. Along with Acoustic management this



drive also features Power management that allows it to power itself down when the drive is not in use or reduce its speed to a lower RPM when lower levels of performance are required.

We tested the WD Caviar Black edition HDD for its performance in real world scenarios using HD tach and SiSoft Sandra, and it did well, but not that much better. It gave us a random access time of 12.3 ms, while the average read and write speeds came to 81.1 and 92 MBps respectively, with CPU utilization at a maximum of 4 per cent. SiSoft Sandra gave it a Drive Index of 80 MBps, and listed the access time as 12 ms.

To sum up, the WD Caviar Black edition HDD

does perform well in our benchmarks, but doesn't really stand apart from the crowd. At Rs 11,700, it's a decent buy for those who don't mind spending extra for a marginal performance boost and some additional features.

Specifications

32 MB buffer, Dual Processors, 1 Terabyte storage space, PMR recording technology

Contact: Western Digital
Phone: 9321029204
E-mail: amarjeet.singh@wdc.com
Web site: www.wdc.com
Price: Rs 11,700

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆